Supreme Court Judgement: It issued various directions to the central government, state governments and union territories aimed at bringing in civil service reforms for the effective, efficient and transparent administration as well as the accountability and stability of civil servants. These are (i) constitution of the Civil Service Boards to guide and advice the governments on transfers, postings, disciplinary action and other service matters, (ii) providing a fixed minimum tenure of service to various civil servants, and (iii) mandating that the civil servants should not act on the basis of verbal or oral instructions, orders, suggestions, proposals and directions and these should be in writing and also formally recorded if given orally.

Impact of the Judgement: This judgement led to the making of amendments in Rule 7 of the IAS, IPS and IFoS (Cadre) Rules vide a notification issued in 2014. For the Central Services, the respective Cadre Controlling Authorities have been directed to implement the above directions of the Supreme Court. However, the Civil Service Boards in the States/UTs are not functioning effectively.

NATIONAL LEGAL SERVICES AUTHORITY CASE (2014)

Name of the Case	: National Legal Services Authority vs. Union of India
Year of Judgement	: 2014
Popular Name	: —
Related Topic/Issue	: Rights of transgender persons
Related Article/Schedule	: 14 & 21

Supreme Court Judgement: It declared Transgenders along with Hijaras/Eunuchs as 'third gender' and held that the fundamental rights granted under Part III of the constitution are equally applicable to them. It also upheld Transgender persons' right to decide their self-identified gender and directed the Central and State Governments to grant legal recognition of their gender identity such as male, female or as third gender.

It also directed the Central and State Governments to take steps to treat them as socially and educationally backward classes of citizens and extend all kinds of reservation in cases of admission in educational institutions and for public appointments. The court held that non-recognition of Transgender denies them equal protection of law under Article 14. If further held that Article 21 protects one's right of self-determination of the gender to which a person belongs. In other words, gender identify is integral to the dignity of an individual and is at the core of 'personal autonomy' and 'self-determination'.

Impact of the Judgement: This judgement led to the enactment of the Transgender Persons (Protection of Rights) Act, 2019. The objective of this act is to provide for protection of rights of transgender persons and their welfare. This act prohibits discrimination against transgender persons and confers right upon them to be recognized as such, and a right to self-perceived gender identity.

Shreya Singhal Case (2015)

Name of the Case	: Shreya Singhal vs. Union of India